N8N AUTOMATION — PORTFOLIO SAMPLE

Lead intake, scoring & routing: every enquiry captured, checked and in front of sales within a minute

Built as a reusable pattern for small service businesses and training centres. The workflow JSON is included and imports into n8n; connect your own Google Sheets, Gmail and Telegram credentials before running.

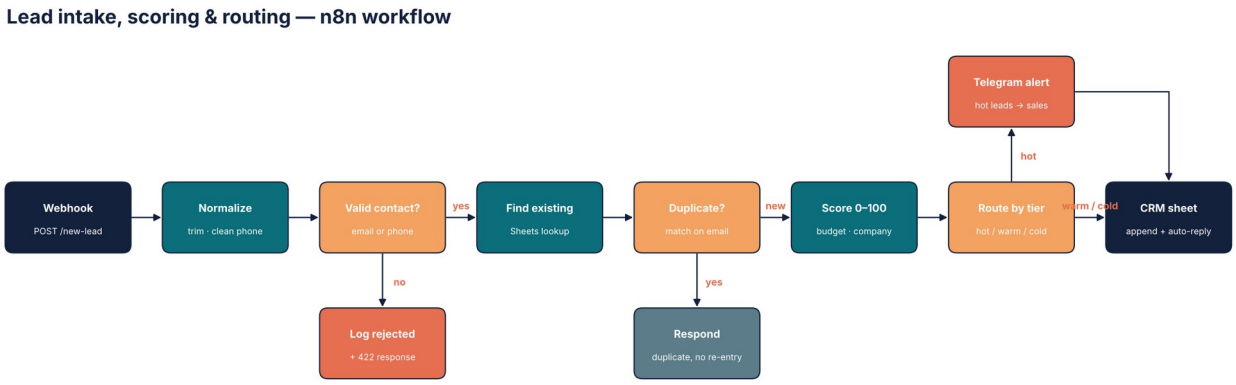
1. The problem it solves

- Enquiries arrive from a website form and get copied into a sheet by hand, often hours later.
- The same person submits twice and gets two calls; bad phone numbers waste follow-up time.
- Sales cannot tell which leads to call first, so high-value enquiries wait in the same queue as everyone else.
- When an integration breaks, nobody notices until a client complains.

2. Before vs after

Step	Before (manual)	After (automated)
Capture	Copy from form email into a sheet	Webhook writes straight to the CRM sheet
Data quality	Typos, mixed formats, duplicates	Fields cleaned; invalid contacts logged and rejected; duplicates blocked by email
Prioritising	First come, first served	Score 0–100 and hot / warm / cold tier on every lead
Hot leads	Seen when someone checks the sheet	Telegram alert to sales in seconds
Client reply	Manual email, if remembered	Personalised auto-reply on every valid lead
Failures	Silent	Error workflow alerts the admin with node, error and execution link

3. How it works



Error workflow: any failed node → Telegram alert to admin (node, error, execution link). Google Sheets nodes retry 3 times, 2 s apart.

4. Scoring rules

Signal	Points	Why
Budget ≥ 500	40	Clear buying intent and size
Budget 150–499	25	Mid-size job
Any budget given	10	Has thought about cost
Company name given	20	Business buyer, repeat potential
Core service (Dashboard, Reporting automation, SOP pack)	20	Matches what we sell best
Phone number given	10	Can be called fast
Source = referral	10	Highest close rate

Signal	Points	Why
Tier	—	Hot ≥ 60 · Warm 35–59 · Cold < 35

Thresholds live in one Code node and are easy to tune to each client's data.

5. Reliability & security

- Google Sheets nodes retry 3 times, 2 seconds apart, before failing.
- A separate Error Trigger workflow sends the admin a Telegram alert with the failing node, error message and execution link.
- The webhook returns clear responses: 200 for accepted or duplicate, 422 for invalid contact details.
- Credentials stay in n8n's credential store; the JSON contains placeholders only, never keys.
- Invalid entries go to a separate "Rejected" tab for review instead of being deleted.

6. Setup in 10 minutes

1. Import lead_intake_scoring_routing.json and error_alert.json into n8n.
2. Create a Google Sheet with tabs "Leads" and "Rejected"; paste its ID in place of REPLACE_WITH_SHEET_ID.
3. Connect Google Sheets, Gmail and Telegram credentials; set the Telegram chat IDs.
4. In workflow settings, choose "Error Alert" as the error workflow.
5. Point the website form to the production webhook URL (/new-lead) and activate.

7. Test cases

Input	Expected result
Email + phone, budget 600, company, Dashboard service, referral	Score 100 → hot → Telegram alert, row in Leads, auto-reply, 200
Valid phone only, no budget	Score 10 → cold → row in Leads, 200
Email already in Leads	No new row, 200 with duplicate: true
Bad email and short phone	Row in Rejected, 422
Google Sheets unavailable	3 retries, then admin alert from error workflow

8. Expected impact

Estimate for a business receiving about 30 enquiries a week, assuming 4 minutes of manual handling per lead: about 2 hours a week saved, hot leads contacted within minutes instead of hours, and zero duplicate calls. Actual results depend on each client's volume and process.